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WEST BENGAL BYPOLLS

EC bars factions from using Trinamool name

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SEMICON INDIA 2026

PM pitches India as hub for chipmaking

NEWS » PAGE 10

NEET-SS CASE

Qualifying percentile will be cut to 30: govt.

NEWS » PAGE 12

PARLEY

Does BRICS meet signify a foreign policy shift?

Delhi declaration slams western sanctions, Israel

OPINION » PAGE 9

DOMINANT DISPLAY

Abhishek dazzles as India sweeps series

SPORT » PAGE 15

U.S. clears Russia sanctions Bill; India faces tariff threat

U.S. House clears legislation that will authorise the President to impose 100% tariffs on countries for buying oil and gas from Russia; committed to ensuring energy security for Indians, says New Delhi

Sriram Lakshman
WASHINGTON DC

The U.S. House of Representatives on Wednesday passed legislation targeting Russia's energy sector, individuals and the "shadow fleet" of tankers, including authorising the U.S. President to impose tariffs of up to 100% on India and other countries for buying oil and gas from Russia. The House voted 262-155 in favour of the Bill.

The Bill, an amendment to the Senate's "Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026", will now head to President Donald Trump's desk for his signature. Mr. Trump plans to sign the Bill, a White House official told *The Hindu* on Thursday. The President will have the authority, under the legislation, to waive sanctions in the national interest.

In its reaction, the Ministry of External Affairs said, "India remains firmly committed to ensuring energy security for its 1.4 billion people" via diversified sourcing of energy inputs, determined according to evolving market forces. India would also "protect its trade and economic interests", it said.

This Bill comes as New Delhi and Washington have been negotiating a preliminary trade deal.

Who are the targets?

The Bill aims to dissuade countries from 'aiding Russian aggression against Ukraine' by purchasing Russian oil and gas

The Bill targets top five "largest importers, by total volume" in the 12 months preceding the date of enactment of the law which have knowingly made new purchases on or after 30 days from the date the Bill becomes law

This issue has been discussed at high levels in recent months with various U.S. interlocutors. Its potential implications for not just the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market have been very clearly articulated by the Indian side.

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS MINISTRY

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12
CHINA, RUSSIA REACT » PAGE 14

Over half of oil imports in July were from Russia

NEW DELHI

Russia accounted for more than 51% of India's oil imports in July, an all-time high, up from just a little less than 50% in the previous month, the latest official data show. An analysis of Commerce and Industry Ministry data shows India imported [illegible] tonnes of Russian oil in July, the latest month for which data are available. » PAGE 11

NEARBY

Thousands attend consecration of Meenakshi temple

MADURAI

Thousands of devotees witnessed the Kumbabhishekam (consecration) of Madurai Sri Meenakshi Sundareswarar Temple on Thursday. » PAGE 4

E.M. Sudarsana Natchiappan dies aged 78

SIVAGANGA

Senior Congress leader and former Union Minister E.M. Sudarsana Natchiappan passed away in Sivaganga on Thursday. He was 78. » PAGE 4

FRIDAY REVIEW » 4 PAGES

Tata Sons Board backs N. Chandrasekaran; Trusts terms it illegal

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

A major dispute has arisen between Tata Sons Pvt. Ltd.'s Board and its majority owner, Tata Trusts, regarding the reappointment of N. Chandrasekaran as Tata Sons chairman and the listing of the company as mandated by Reserve Bank of India guidelines. Tata Trusts has termed the appointment "illegal".

On Thursday, at a scheduled board meeting of Tata Sons, the Board requested Mr. Chandrasekaran to reconsider his decision to not seek reappointment and continue for five years, and he "acceded to the request".

"The Board thereafter resolved by a majority vote to re-appoint him as Executive Chairman for a further term of five years upon the expiry of his current tenure [in February 2027]," Tata Sons said in a statement.

N. Chandrasekaran

On August 12, Mr. Chandrasekaran had said that he would not seek reappointment since one board member, Noel Tata, did not approve it.

NOEL TATA OPPOSED BID » PAGE 13

T.N. says CM's U.K. trip drew ₹15,300-crore investment commitments

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who visited the U.K. to meet industrialists and attract investments to the State, returned to Chennai on Thursday. A press release said investment commitments worth ₹15,300 crore had been received during the visit, which would generate 10,000 direct and indirect jobs.

Mr. Vijay met Indian High Commissioner [illegible] Periyasamy and held discussions on joint ventures between India and the U.K. under the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA).

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 6

After claiming death benefits, 2,500 Odisha workers return for ration

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

In a bid to hoodwink Odisha's welfare machinery, almost 2,500 construction workers appear to have defied the rules of mortality – they died on paper, collected death benefits, and then came back to life to authenticate their Aadhaar and collect their monthly ration.

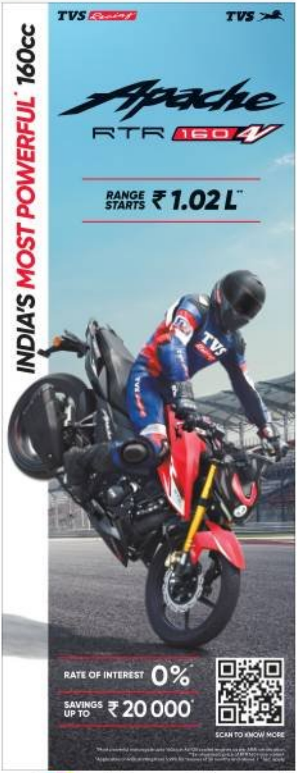
An audit has blown the lid off what appears to be a bizarre and massive fraud under the State's Nirman Shramik welfare scheme. As many as 2,487 construction workers were declared dead and their nominees were paid death assistance, even though the workers continued to draw subsidised food grains under the National Food Security Act (NFSA) and State Food Security Scheme after their recorded deaths.

ILLUSTRATION: SOUMYADIP SINHA

The contradiction becomes even more startling in 751 cases. The audit found that these beneficiaries authenticated their Aadhaar biometrically to obtain ration after they had officially been declared dead. Death assistance amounting to ₹15.02 crore was subsequently paid to their nominees.

In other words, the government's records had buried the workers, while its ration system was still recognising their fingerprints.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10



IN BRIEF

Prof. K.S. Hegde Memorial Endowment Lecture held

[illegible]

City hospital treats man with year-long severe pelvic pain

[illegible]

Sembakkam Lake continues to suffer sewage pollution

[illegible]

[illegible]

Police receive more allegations of sexual abuse against granite baron R. Veeramani

[illegible]

'Today's Chennai is bustling on several fronts, but my heart still beats for the old Madras'

[illegible]

Man held for cheating woman of 155 sovereigns of gold jewellery

[illegible]

CINEMA • ARTS • EVENTS

[illegible]

CLASSIFIEDS MART

[illegible]

Classifieds Special

REAL ESTATE

[illegible]

RENTAL

[illegible]

IN BRIEF

GCC officials mark Periyar's birth anniversary with pledge

[illegible]

Pay property, professional tax by September 30: Corporation

[illegible]

Traffic police to set up 15 centres to help motorists clear pending e-challans

[illegible]

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

[illegible]

Mantra

Four persons held for robbing bank employee of ₹11 lakh, laptop in T. Nagar

The Hindu Bureau

The police recovered [illegible] lakh of the stolen money, and seized a two-wheeler used in the robbery

[illegible]

Webinar on Alzheimer's Dementia care to be held on Sept. 20

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

History-sheeter dies at Puzhal Central Prison

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

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IN BRIEF

Officials review measures in preparation for [illegible]

[illegible]

Parts of T.N. see summer-like temperatures this September

[illegible]

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

[illegible]

Rela Hospital launches centre for specialised cleft, craniofacial care

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

Three persons arrested in migrant worker murder case

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

GCC identifies 2,079 defunct streetlights across city

The Hindu Bureau

[illegible]

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

4TH DEATH ANNIVERSARY

DEEP DEATH CONDOLENCE

[illegible]

ARUN MIRANDA

[illegible]

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION AND RESEARCH
NOTIFICATION

[illegible]

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From Page One

Govt. says CM's U.K. trip drew ₹15,516 crore investment commitments

[illegible]

Thousands of devotees witness consecration of Sri Meenakshi Sundareswarar Temple

[illegible]

[illegible]

What did you do in the past year, NGT asks govt. over idol immersion

[illegible]

Why build a new Secretariat at a time of financial crisis, asks Palaniswami

[illegible]

Minister counters Premallatha's remarks on VCK-TVK alliance

[illegible]

CCB summons former Minister in fraud case

[illegible]

E.M. Sudarsana Natchiappan, former Union Minister and senior Congress leader, passes away aged 78

[illegible]

National integration must involve equal rights for citizens: V-P

[illegible]

Navodaya case: SC tells T.N. to change 'anti-Hindi' mindset

[illegible]

Former DGP sentenced in illegal assets case

[illegible]

WEATHERWATCH

[illegible]

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Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India

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Complex priorities

[illegible]

New fault lines

[illegible]

The crucial Uttar Pradesh test of the BJP's hegemony

[illegible]

A war room for India in an age of sanctions

[illegible]

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

[illegible]

Does the BRICS summit signify a shift for Indian foreign policy?

AI makes editors read the writer as well as the text

PICTURE OF THE WEEK

Chasing the sunset

FROM THE ARCHIVES The Hindu.

Bright future for computers in India

A lecture on advertising

From Page One

U.S. passes Bill targeting Russian energy sector

[illegible]

Declared dead, workers come back to get ration

[illegible]

PM pitches India as a global destination for chipmaking

[illegible]

[illegible]

Plea flagging issues in Delhi SIR to get 'precedence' in SC

[illegible]

Noel Tata opposes bid for Chandrasekaran's return

[illegible]

Two Jaish terrorists killed, suspect held in Udhampur

[illegible]

Court issues arrest warrant against LeT commander

[illegible]

Kuki-Zo Council warns of full-fledged agitation if demands are not met

[illegible]

Centre must make stance clear on U.S. law: Congress

[illegible]

[illegible]

Govt. says introduction of MDR will help Indian UPI apps, denies foreign push

[illegible]

Cong. rejects claims that its MPs backed MDR move

[illegible]

EC bars rival factions from using Trinamool name and symbol for Assembly bypolls

[illegible]

Wishes, messages pour in for Modi as the PM celebrates 76th birthday

[illegible]

SC seeks report on 25 unnatural deaths in Manipur camps

[illegible]

[illegible]

IN BRIEF

Centre proposes CCTV surveillance at medical stores

[illegible]

SC notice to Centre, State over woman's deportation

[illegible]

CBFC calls for action against screening of Umar Khalid film

[illegible]

HC refuses to interfere with order on Raintree by CMO

[illegible]

Defer Class 6 language policy roll-out to 2027: SC to Centre

[illegible]

[illegible]

NEET-SS qualifying percentile will be reduced to 30: govt.

[illegible]

PAC pulls up Railways over gaps in amenities despite promises

[illegible]

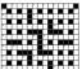
[illegible]

Stem cell therapy for autism only in approved clinical trials: Centre

[illegible]

[illegible]

CROSSWORD



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SUDOKU

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6		8		3				5
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5					9	8		
8	6						7	2
		3	7					9
					3	6		
1				9		3		8
				8	7	4	9	

FAITH

Kallazhagar and Ramanuja

[illegible]

IN BRIEF

TVS expects single-digit growth for 2-wheeler industry

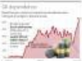
[illegible]

Govt. puts 25 coal blocks on sale in 14th round of auctions

[illegible]

51% of India's July oil imports from Russia

[illegible]



[illegible]

India softens EU steel import curbs hit, secures 80% exports

[illegible]

SEBI will hear broker, AMC concerns on [illegible]: Pandey

[illegible]

Semicon 2.0 locks in chip assets sale

[illegible]

'Oil India to spend ₹15,000 crore on deepwater exploration over 3 years'

[illegible]

[illegible]

India's August crude imports dropped 3%, spend rose 18%: data

[illegible]

PSU general insurers log ₹10,051-crore loss, pvt. insurers in green

[illegible]

AHMEDABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

[illegible]

SANAA

Yemen's Houthis say Saudi strikes killed one, targeted telecom towers

[illegible]

JERUSALEM

Israel adds tender for 2,867 units to settlement expansion plan

[illegible]

WASHINGTON

U.S. again denies Palestinian leader Abbas visa to attend UN assembly

[illegible]

ISLAMABAD

Pakistan, China activate boundary joint commission in Islamabad

[illegible]

China opposes U.S. sanctions Bill; Russia says it could hinder peace

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

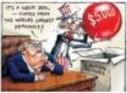
UN experts cite possible U.S. war crimes in Iran hits

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

On the draw


IT'S A GREAT DEAL — [illegible] FROM THE WORLD'S LARGEST DEMOCRACY!

China, U.S. top diplomats, in call, discuss 'high-level interactions'

[illegible]

[illegible]

Carney pushes 'new alliance' with EU despite Trump threats

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

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Abhishek smashes fastest ton in a T20I featuring Test-playing nations

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Abhishek breaks record for highest percentage of runs in boundaries

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Vlaeminck and Hills claim three each as Australia A thrash India A

[illegible]

Pakistan overcome Thailand scare to reach Asian Games semifinals

[illegible]

Abhishek's hurricane hundred powers Men in Blue's emphatic series sweep

[illegible]

[illegible]

Nihal saves the day for India; women cruise

[illegible]

For Japan's cricket team, the occasion means more

[illegible]

Chaos and crisis: Japan in an alternate universe?

[illegible]

IN BRIEF

Raphinha leads Barcelona's rout of Santander with hat-trick

[illegible]

East Bengal held in its AFC CL Two opener

[illegible]

Sri Lanka's hero Dunith bags ICC Player of the Month

[illegible]

Martinelli replaces Pedro for Brazil's India, Australia games

[illegible]

Messi scores [illegible] goal as club lifts Campeones Cup

[illegible]

It's basically who wants it more on the day: Nagal

[illegible]

[illegible]

'Indian athletes can improve on Hangzhou tally'

[illegible]

'Anahat's attacking game makes her a very unusual player'

[illegible]

BBL chief promises an authentic Big Bash experience in Chennai

[illegible]

AROUND THE CITY

[illegible]

Rain could mar India-Australia youth ODI series opener

[illegible]

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INDIA iSTORE

Cold blood, hot streak

An Achilles injury, just four days of practice, and a final against the top seed and two-time defending champion... Rybakina's path to the US Open title was anything but simple. However, her tennis made it look that way. In the process, she ascended to the top of the world rankings

GETTY IMAGES

Anirudh Velamuri

Sport has an old rule about momentum: catch fire late in a season, and the off-season usually douses it. That sentiment holds for most part. But, as with most things in life, there are exceptions. Elena Rybakina's is one.

The Russian-born Kazakh couldn't get past the fourth round at the Grand Slams last year. Form looked to have deserted her and the season was all set to be chalked up as yet another 'learning experience' in her career.

Then, it all changed.

She came through a tough set of tournaments in September and October, won in Ningbo and closed the year by defeating Aryna Sabalenka in the WTA Finals title decider, taking home more than five million in prize money, the biggest purse in women's tennis history at that time.

The soft-spoken 27-year-old later disappeared for the off-season. When she returned to action, she picked up from where she had left off, looking just as dangerous as she'd been. Rybakina reached the Australian Open final without dropping a set, clawed back from 0-3 down in the third set to beat Sabalenka again for her second Major. She became the first player in eight years to win the WTA Finals and the Australian Open in succession.

Rybakina wins the way glaciers move: silently, relentlessly, until you look up one day and the entire landscape has changed. New York didn't just hand her a trophy; it handed women's tennis a warning wrapped in ice — quiet on the outside, catastrophic underneath

What followed was, by any measure, a strong season: a title in Stuttgart along with runner-up finishes at Indian Wells and the Canadian Open. She also hauled her 400th career win on the way.

The underlying numbers are absurd. Since last year's US Open, nobody on the Tour has won more matches than Rybakina (62) and nobody has beaten more top-10 players (16, with a 16-6 record). She leads the field in winners (1,503), in aces (394) and break points saved (65.3%). She made six finals (tied with Jessica Pegula for most on the Tour) and clinched four crowns, more than anyone else.

Put it all together and you get a first-time World No. 1: the first from Kazakhstan, and at 27 years and 80 days, the second-oldest woman ever to reach the summit for the first time. She rose to the top, tournament by tournament, so relentlessly that by the time it actually happened, nobody blinked.

And yet a year ago, the idea of Rybakina dethroning Sabalenka looked unthinkable, unattainable even. Last September, she had 3,833 points to Sabalenka's 11,226 — barely a third. By last month, that gap had shrunk to 350 points, before she finally ended Sabalenka's 59-week reign at the No. 1.

Even before she ascended to the top of the rankings, Rybakina had already beaten a reigning World No. 1 nine times, a mark bettered only by Gabriela Sabatini's 10. The Kazakh has now beaten nine of the last 10 women who have held the top ranking. Only Ashleigh Barty got away.

Crowning moment

Impressive as all that is, the true crowning moment of Rybakina's year came at Flushing Meadows: she barely stumbled, let alone look anywhere near beatable. The strange part is that heading into the tournament, nobody was asking how far she'd go. They were instead wondering if she'd play at all.

On August 14, she was steamrollered by Iga Swiatek in the Canadian Open title. A week later, Rybakina was forced to retire after just five games of her Cincinnati quarterfinal against the same opponent.

An Achilles injury was suspected, though little else was confirmed. In the week before the US Open, Rybakina barely picked up a racquet. As far as preparation for one of the biggest titles in the sport goes, it was far from ideal.

"It wasn't the best time, for sure, because I was so upset. I didn't know how it was going to be, day by day. We arrived in New York, did an MRI and it didn't look that great. We had to talk with a lot of doctors to get an opinion on what we should do," she said, hours after conquering New York.

She started practising just four days before the US Open got underway and with each match, she looked less like a woman shaking off rust and more like one reminding everyone who she was. The power was there and the aces were pulled out of nowhere when they were needed the most.

"Just four days of practice, a lot of belief in myself and talking with the team [illegible] about the tactics... that's how I played in Canada, how I played in Cincinnati. I mean, it's just so many things. Everything went my way. I'm shocked."

Her tennis over the fortnight told a different story. Nothing about this triumph was shocking. Everything came together for Rybakina one way or the other.

Sabalenka loves to feast on her opponent's second serve, as Pegula was harshly reminded in the semifinals. So when Rybakina landed just eight of her 30 first serves in the opening set of the final, logic dictated that the Belarusian would seize control of the contest.

The logic was wrong. Rybakina pulled out heavier, quicker second serves and deep, powerful groundstrokes to put Sabalenka on the back foot. If one moment captured how the final unfolded, it was the last game of the opening set, where Rybakina couldn't hit a first serve but ended up on top despite everything thrown at her.

By the end of the night, as she did at the WTA Finals, Rybakina had a trophy and a fat cheque in hand, but this time as World No. 1. Four years ago, she barely managed a smile after conquering Wimbledon, and the tennis world wondered if she'd ever let herself feel a title the way champions are supposed to. In New York, something shifted. The fists were raised, the celebration stayed brief, however, underneath it, for the first time, was an unmistakable and hard-earned joy.

Rybakina wins the way glaciers move: silently, relentlessly, until you look up one day and the entire landscape has changed. New York didn't just hand her a trophy; it handed women's tennis a warning wrapped in ice — quiet on the outside, catastrophic on the inside.

A year earlier, after finishing runner-up to Rybakina at the WTA Finals, Sabalenka — far from being tennis' most gracious loser — was overheard reaching for a Russian idiom that translated to: "Once a year, even a stick shoots," suggesting Rybakina's form was little more than a fluke. Famous last words.

Overcoming controversy

Like most of the sport's best players, Rybakina hasn't always made headlines for the right reasons. First came the injuries and health scares that dragged her out of tournaments through 2024 and '25. Then her 'worrying' relationship with coach Stefano Vukov landed under the microscope.

In September 2024, she fired Vukov and hired Novak Djokovic's former coach Goran Ivanisevic, before reinstating Vukov. A WTA investigation later found that Vukov had engaged in abusive conduct towards Rybakina, and he was banned from coaching at WTA events in January 2025. The ban was overturned on appeal that August.

Rybakina never softened her stance towards the WTA through it all, even declining to pose for a photo with the then-CEO Portia Archer after beating Sabalenka to win the WTA Finals on November 8.

Long before the WTA formally looked into the Vukov relationship, fans and pundits had already suspected that something was off. He was always very vocal in relentlessly criticising during matches, well beyond any reasonable idea of 'tough love' coaching.

One can argue that Vukov has been noticeably softer since the ban ended. Criticism has largely given way to encouragement. Optimists will call it a man who learnt his lesson. Cynics will call it a man who learnt to behave when the cameras were rolling.

Rybakina herself has stayed quiet on the specifics, but she's hinted that having her team back in place has mattered.

"I think I have a very good team and good people around me now. It definitely helps. A lot was going on in the previous year outside of the court. I think now all my focus is on tennis. I can't always perform at my best. There are always ups and downs, but I think we've been doing a very good job, taking the right decisions at certain situations, because every day is a challenge," she said last week.

The Vukov chapter may never be fully closed in public, but it changes nothing about where Rybakina stands right now. What once looked like a hot streak has long since stopped resembling one. Nothing about her has come out as a fluke.

She will now head into tournaments, starting with the China Open later this month, as the top seed and a clear title favourite. Given how balanced she is in success and adversity, none of that seems likely to rattle her.

"I feel like you will appreciate and think about it [becoming World No. 1] even more when you finish your career. For now, you need to keep going. You never know how long you're going to stay. All my thoughts are just for the next match," she said after her quarterfinal win over Qinwen Zheng.

Call it humility. Call it how elite athletes are wired. Call it a deliberate way of shrugging off the spotlight before it gets too heavy. Whatever it is, one thing isn't up for debate: the girl who once played tennis as an after-school pastime, who didn't consider it a career until she was 17, has walked out of New York as the most dominant force in women's tennis. Rybakina is pure potential energy, coiled at the very peak of her arc. Buckle up.

THE GIST

- Since the 2025 US Open, nobody on the Tour has won more matches than Rybakina (62) and nobody has beaten more top-10 players (16, with a 16-6 record) than her
- In the same period, the Kazakh made six finals (tied with Pegula for most on the Tour) and won four titles, more than anyone else
- An Achilles issue nearly kept her out of this season's US Open. She recovered in time to go all the way, beating Sabalenka in the final
- Last year, Rybakina couldn't go past the fourth round at the Slams. This season, she has won two Majors and also become the new World No. 1
- By September 2025, she had 3,833 points to Sabalenka's 11,226 — barely a third. In the space of 12 months, Rybakina has overturned that deficit and ended the latter's 59-week reign at the top of the rankings
- The ace is Rybakina's most potent weapon and she served the most aces (136) in a Slam in New York this year. In fact, she served an ace on championship point at both the Australian Open and US Open

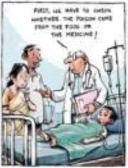
Why patient safety needs more than hospital checklists

[illegible]

[illegible]

THE GIST

[illegible]


FIRST, WE HAVE TO CHECK WHETHER THE POISON CAME FROM THE FOOD OR THE MEDICINE!

Melanoma in India: messaging about skin cancer needs to change, to catch it early

[illegible]

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Increase in Indian utilities' August coal imports

5.52 [illegible]

Number of deceased persons returned to Ukraine by Russia

252 [illegible]

Private capital attracted by the World Bank

112 [illegible]

Amount to be spent on defence by Ukraine in 2027

4.9 [illegible]

Number of taluks declared drought-hit in Karnataka

124 [illegible]

What is the Uniform Civil Code debate?

[illegible]

UNIFORM
CIVIL
CODE

[illegible]

THE GIST

[illegible]

Why was ex-Kosovo President convicted by The Hague?

[illegible]

EXPLAINER

Who has to pay MDR on UPI and who stands to gain the most?

[illegible]

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

[illegible]

Word of the day

[illegible]

THE DAILY QUIZ

Test yourself on the Indian odyssey at the Asian Games ahead of the 20th edition starting in Aichi-Nagoya on Saturday

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